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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 3 : Session – 9 | Socially Relevant Projects

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. The PURPOSE of socially relevant projects in value education is to move from understanding to LIVING — to verify the proposals of harmony in actual work with people and nature. Classroom discussion develops clarity; projects develop competence and commitment. A socially relevant project is one whose outcome contributes directly to the comprehensive human goal — right understanding, prosperity in families, fearlessness in society, co-existence with nature — not merely a technical or commercial output.
2. Q2. The ESSENTIAL CRITERION: the project must be judged by its impact on the HUMAN GOAL, not by scale, profit or publicity. The tree-plantation example shows this: planting 100 saplings that all die is worth less than planting 10 that are nurtured to survive — the criterion is actual ENRICHMENT (survival, growth, benefit to people and nature), not the count planted. Similarly, an awareness drive is relevant only if conduct actually changes. So the criterion is: does it demonstrably move some family, community or ecosystem toward mutual fulfilment?
3. Q3. The FIVE DIMENSIONS to check in any project: (1) EDUCATION-SANSKAR — does it develop understanding/commitment in people? (2) HEALTH-SELF-REGULATION — does it improve health and discipline? (3) PRODUCTION-WORK — does it enable mutually enriching production? (4) JUSTICE-PRESERVATION — does it strengthen just relationships and protect nature? (5) EXCHANGE-STORAGE — does it create fair exchange and secure storage for mutual prosperity? And it must serve the FOUR HUMAN GOALS (right understanding in every self, prosperity in every family, fearlessness in society, co-existence in nature). A project scoring on all dimensions is truly socially relevant.
4. Q4. THREE types of projects: (1) STUDY projects — surveying and analysing a reality (e.g., studying water usage in a hostel to find wastage patterns); (2) MODEL projects — developing a small working prototype of the solution (e.g., a composting pit or rainwater-harvesting unit for one block); (3) IMPLEMENTATION projects — scaling a proven model into regular practice with people (e.g., establishing composting across the whole campus with stakeholder participation). The three are progressive: study -> model -> implementation.
5. Q5. MY PROJECT PROPOSAL: 'Campus Food-Waste to Compost Loop' — (a) STUDY phase: measure daily food waste in the mess and interview staff/students on awareness; (b) MODEL phase: set up one composting unit converting a week's waste into manure for campus gardens; (c) IMPLEMENTATION phase: hand over a running system to the mess committee with student volunteers and an awareness board showing monthly waste reduced. HUMAN-GOAL mapping: it develops understanding and sanskar in participants (education-sanskar), enriches soil instead of landfill (co-existence with nature), and demonstrates right utilisation (prosperity thinking). Its relevance criterion: measured reduction in waste and actual compost produced — not the number of posters put up.